party was adopting was actually the ‘jan-kalyanwad’ of Indian tradition and the ‘integral humanism’ advocated by Deen Dayal Upadhyaya.

- BJP formally adopts ‘Gandhian socialism’ as a founding ideology for the new party in its inaugural policy statement.

28–30 December 1980: The BJP’s first organised attempt at mobilising the women’s vote with the launch of the BJP Mahila Morcha (women’s front) convened by Jayawantiben Mehta and inaugurated by the party’s first female vice president, Vijaya Raje Scindia.

December 1980: Nanaji Deshmukh withdraws from the party’s organisational affairs, moves to Gonda (Madhya Pradesh), and later to Chitrakoot, to work on rural education and farming cooperatives.

1984: After Indira Gandhi’s assassination, Nanaji Deshmukh says the Congress’s Rajiv Gandhi deserved ‘cooperation and sympathy’ for larger causes.

1984: The BJP wins only two Lok Sabha seats: its lowest ever in national elections.

1985: Vajpayee commissions a twelve-member working group to review the party and asks if Jan Sangh made a mistake merging with the Janata Party in 1977. Asks if BJP should go back and revive Jan Sangh. Working Group says no and creates a blueprint for revival.

1985: Assam Accord by the Rajiv Gandhi government specifically lists a key demand of the Assam movement for ‘detection, deletion and deportation’ of illegal Bangladeshi migrants. Puts a migration cut-off date of 24 March 1971, the year of the India–Pakistan war.

1 February 1986: Rajiv Gandhi-led Union government enables the opening of the locks on the disputed Babri Masjid for ‘Hindu worshippers’.

1986: The BJP issues its first Economic Policy.

25 September 1988: Narendra Modi’s name first appears as a politician in the pages of *The Times of India* as the organiser of an anti-Congress rasta-roko agitation on farmers’ demands in Gujarat.